South Wales Police — Forensic Assessment

Version 1.0.0 · 2026-10-23

Editors of the Great House Farm Legal Wiki

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Page 1558 of the Great House Farm Legal Wiki, carried over from the version last modified on 2026-10-21. The same page is published at research.bucklerfamily.estate, and this version is also a PDF in the wayback archive.

1 Release notes

1.1 This release (version 1.0.0)

- **2026-Oct-23** - Carried over to the docs library from Legal Wiki page 1558 (last modified 2026-10-21 19:41:12 UTC). The page text, dates and references are as on the wiki. Links to wiki pages lead to the same page on research.bucklerfamily.estate; images are links to their files on the wiki.

1.2 Older versions

None yet.

2 Record

This material now lives at https://fcg.bucklerfamily.estate/case/south-wales-police-forensic-institutional-review**.**

Page ID: 1558 · **Title:** South Wales Police — Forensic Assessment · **Evidence status:** Not yet labelled — see the Editing Protocol · **Version:** 1.0.0 · Editing Protocol

Email dialogue evidence: every email exchanged with South Wales Police about Great House Farm is catalogued word for word, by thread and date, at South Wales Police — Email Correspondence Catalogue (continued in Part 2 and Part 3).

Chronology and catalogue links — assessed 10-10-2026: Use the Institutional Involvement Roadmap (1877–2026) for the date-ordered institution/people/evidence sequence. The reported 1988 Cadw-to-Minister spot-listing letter has its own catalogue placeholder at GHF-E152; the original has not been attached to that page as at 10-10-2026. A placeholder records an evidence gap; it does not establish the letter's contents or misconduct.

2.1 Forensic Assessment — South Wales Police

Scope: policing records connected with the eviction/demolition episode and later reporting; not civil title adjudication.

2.1.1 Current evidence

The project has a confirmed negative FOI outcome under reference 719/26. That is a search result, not proof that no historic operational record ever existed. [?]

2.1.2 Forensic control test

Identify the specific incident, operational record class, command/force area, retention rule and any transferred or destroyed records. Separate police operational decisions from the civil court authority under which possession was enforced.

2.1.3 Current finding

As at 10-10-2026, the material reviewed does not establish policing misconduct. This is not a finding that the historic police role or every operational act has been established or excluded. The current work concerns historical-record recovery and the evidential status of reports/footage about the 1988 episode.

2.1.4 Human action

Seek the search methodology and retention/disposal explanation behind FOI 719/26, and cross-check any surviving court warrant, press footage or contemporaneous account before alleging operational excess.

Acceptance: a defensible police-record search/retention trail and any relevant incident references are logged.

Cross-institution records route: the NPCC's September–October 2026 correspondence searched accessible national /ACPO holdings and referred the requester toward individual police forces; it does not substitute for this force's local operational records search. Compare the NPCC forensic assessment, especially GHF-E106-R49 and GHF-E106-R51, with South Wales Police's own FOI 719/26 record (R38) and the linked press evidence below. A national nil return and a local nil return are separate searches.

2.2 South Wales Police — chronological evidence map

This map separates the date of the event from the date/type of the source. Newspaper reports are evidence of what was reported, not automatic proof of every reported detail; testimony of named family members is labelled separately and linked to their Testimony pages. Select each source title to open the evidence page.

Event / record date	Appearance documented	Direct source and qualification
29 April 1988 (event date inferred from contemporary report dated/circa 30 April)	First bailiff eviction attempt. A press report says five bailiffs and around 15 police officers attended; a South Wales Police spokesperson is reported as saying officers were there to prevent a breach of the peace, not to assist bailiffs.	GHF-E090-N07 — "Chainsaw farmer vows to fight on". The newspaper title /date is approximate; the article says "yesterday" about the events.
30 April 1988 (publication date; same incident, not necessarily a second deployment)	South Wales Echo search extract reports a dozen police officers were on the farm as bailiffs tried to evict the family. This is a short archive search-result extract, not the complete article.	GHF-E090-N15-02 — South Wales Echo extract · search-extract evidence page.
September 2026 (Branwen's recollection recorded then)	Branwen's recollection of the November 1988 removal, Sep 2026 (GHF-E114; Branwen testimony), says the men detaining her appeared to be soldiers. It does not identify them as South Wales Police, and the account remains uncorroborated.	GHF-E114 — Branwen testimony. Contextual lead only; not evidence of SWP deployment. [?]
16 July 2026 (FOI response)	South Wales Police reports no information held for the requested period 1900–1993 about police attendance at, or support for bailiffs at, the property. [?]	Reply register R38 — FOI 719/26. A nil return concerns records held/search results; it does not erase the contemporary press reports.

29 September 2026 (FOI response)	South Wales Police says it does not hold the requested information about named individuals.	Reply register R39 — FOI 1040/26.
29–30 September 2026 (SAR administration)	Additional subject-access correspondence is recorded, but its personal-data contents are not reproduced on the public Wiki.	R12 · R46. Procedural appearance only; not substantive evidence about 1988 conduct.

Unresolved boundary: the current published material still lacks the local force's underlying 1988 operational, incident, custody and deployment records. The late-November possession and demolition reports should not be used to infer police attendance unless a specific source identifies the officers or force. The national NPCC search is a separate records route; compare the NPCC forensic assessment. [?]

2.2.1 Records-access register appearances — direct row links

Rows below match the institution's name or an alias in the reply register's sender/reference or recorded description. A match shows an appearance in the records trail, not necessarily an act by this institution.

Date	Correspondence / register item (click to open)	Reading rule
16 Jul 2026	R38 — South Wales Police FOI. 719/26 .	Register row contains a name/alias match; inspect the linked row to distinguish sender, recipient and incidental mention.
29 Sep 2026	R12 — South Wales Police, subject access team.	Register row contains a name/alias match; inspect the linked row to distinguish sender, recipient and incidental mention.
29 Sep 2026	R39 — South Wales Police FOI. 1040/26 .	Register row contains a name/alias match; inspect the linked row to distinguish sender, recipient and incidental mention.
30 Sep 2026	R46 — South Wales Police, SAR concerning the 20 Aug 2026 request	Register row contains a name/alias match; inspect the linked row to distinguish sender, recipient and incidental mention.

Related navigation: FOI & Public-Authority Reply Register · Records Access Chronology · Evidence Library

2.3 Page version & change log

Current version: 1.0.1

Version	Date (UTC)	Editor (human or agent name)	Change	Source / evidence
1.0.1	2026-10-20T22:01Z	Sion's Tab agent	Surname removed from Branwen's name in our own text (first name only, public naming rule). Quoted documents and correspondence unchanged. Nothing else changed.	Public naming rule / Master Change Log (3923)
1.0.0	2026-10-18T15:29Z	Sion's Tab agent	Footer standardised; earlier log rows carried into this table; no content change	Editing Protocol, 18 Oct 2026

	2026-10-18 (rollout date; exact time not separately recorded)	OpenAI-assisted maintenance agent (GPT-6)	Installed this page-local append-only change log and agent instructions. Existing page content was not intentionally rewritten.	User-directed site-wide changelog standard. Saved via WordPress API; public rendering of this page not yet independently checked.

Agents and editors: follow the Editing Protocol.